

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 3
♥ A Q 7
♦ J 10 8 7 3
♣ K 6

♠ A Q 10

♥ K 4 3

♦ K Q 9 2

♣ Q 8 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 5 2

♥ J 10 6 5 2

♦ 6 4

♣ 9 3

♠ J 6 4

♥ 9 8

♦ A 5

♣ A J 10 7 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

If his honor is not the ♥K then it won't matter whether you play ♥A or ♥Q to the first trick; you will win your two top cards and then play your small one back to East.

So assume North actually holds the ♥K x x. If you play the ♥A to trick one, then lead ♥Q, North will hold up on the second trick, and win the third ♥. Then, when you win your ♣K you will not have a ♥ to return to partner and declarer will make the contract.

So what happens if you play the ♥Q at trick one? North could still make the contract by holding up, **but he will be afraid to do so**. After all, from his perspective it looks like East probably holds the ♥A and he will be afraid of losing the first 5 ♥ tricks, perhaps even when the ♣K finessing is working!

[showcards W:H5 N:H8]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥8

Play the ♥Q.

The Rule of Eleven tells you there are 6 cards in South, West and North that are higher than the ♥5. You can see 5 of them, so that leaves just one of them for North.

East cannot have all three of the outstanding honors, because from ♥K J 10 x x his correct lead would be the Jack. So you can deduce that North must hold exactly one of ♥K, ♥J, or ♥10.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 8 3
 ♥ 10 6
 ♦ 7 5 2
 ♣ A K Q 5

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ 10 9 8 4

♣ 10 8 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 9 6 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ K J 3

♣ J 6

♠ K 5

♥ Q J 9 7 2

♦ A Q 6

♣ 9 7 3

West

1 ♣

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by East

put you back on lead with your ♥ A. You play the ♦ 9 and your side will collect 3 ♦ tricks to go with your 2 ♥s.

North

Pass

East

1 ♠

South

2 ♥

[showcards W:HQ N:H6]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥ Q, dummy played the ♥ 6

Overtake with the ♥ K.

Your side needs to take 5 tricks to defeat this contract. Two of them will be ♥s, but it doesn't look like you can win any ♣s or ♠s.

That means you need to win 3 ♦ tricks and the only way that can happen is if you play ♦s from your side.

So win the first ♥ K (so partner will know you also have the ♥ A), and play the ♦ 10. Presumably East will play an honor, but South will take the trick and

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Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 8 6 4

♥ 8

♦ 7 4 2

♣ A J 9

♠ J 3

♥ K Q J 6

♦ A K Q 10 5

♣ 6 2



♠ 10

♥ 7 3 2

♦ 9 8 6 3

♣ Q 7 5 4 3

♠ 9 7 5 2

♥ A 10 9 5 4

♦ J

♣ K 10 8

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

from your side of the table, and the way to make that happen is for you to ruff partner's ♠ K with an otherwise useless trump. You still get your two ♠ winners (sort of) but now you get to play a ♣ through South's ♣ K at trick 3.

[showcards W:SK N:SJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ A, then the ♠ K. Dummy follows suit and it is your play to the second trick.

Ruff partner's ♠ K.

It is obvious that your side can only get 2 ♠ tricks. And assuming that South has the Ace of trumps you will not make a single trick in the red suits. So you need to make 2 ♣ tricks.

If partner has the ♣ A K then he will take them, but if he has the ♣ A J he cannot win 2 ♣ tricks from his side.

To allow for this situation it will be better to play ♣s